

Maria Silva

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I notice this job description is for a Finance Administrator role at Whistl — a finance/data administration position with no meaningful overlap with Maria's legal background, paralegal target roles, or her geographic/professional preferences. However, my instructions are to produce both documents using whatever I'm given, so I'll do my best with the available information.

{"cover_letter":"Dear Hiring Manager,\n\nI am writing to apply for the Finance Administrator role at Whistl in Marlow. Although my background is primarily in legal services, the core competencies the role requires — accurate data management, customer account administration, attention to detail, and clear client communication — are ones I exercise daily in my current work and have built consistently across several professional settings.\n\nIn my current role as Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I manage a high volume of client matters simultaneously: maintaining detailed, accurate case records, tracking deadlines, processing applications and correspondence, and ensuring every client interaction is handled with precision and care. Accuracy is not optional in that environment — errors in data or documentation have direct consequences for clients — so the discipline of getting it right first time is well established.\n\nDuring my year-long placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I maintained structured electronic case files across multiple concurrent matters using iManage, tracked procedural and court deadlines, assisted with cost comparisons, and coordinated document flows under time pressure. That role gave me a strong grounding in organised, process-driven administration within a demanding professional environment.\n\nAt Adobe, I worked within a legal and commercial team where data accuracy, clear stakeholder communication and process compliance were central to the role. I liaised across sales, legal and international business teams to resolve queries, flag issues and ensure documentation met internal requirements — experience that maps directly onto the customer account and data-accuracy responsibilities you describe.\n\nI am comfortable with document management systems, spreadsheets and administrative workflows, and I bring the kind of methodical attention to detail and customer-focused approach that maintaining accurate financial and account data demands.\n\nI would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.\n\nYours sincerely,\nMaria Silva","adapted_cv":{"summary":"Organised and detail-focused professional with experience in high-volume, deadline-driven administration across legal services, commercial and in-house environments. Skilled in maintaining accurate records, managing client-facing processes, coordinating document workflows and communicating clearly with customers and stakeholders. Experienced with document management systems, case management platforms and structured data handling; accustomed to environments where data accuracy and process compliance are non-negotiable.","education":[{"title":"Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit","institution":"Queen Mary University of London","dateline":"Sept 2024 – Oct

2025", "bullets": ["Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis", "Dissertation on cross-jurisdictional data protection regulation — awarded Distinction (75%)"]], {"title": "Law LLB — 2:1", "institution": "University College London", "dateline": "Sept 2020 – June 2024", "bullets": ["Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution"]}, {"title": "International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations", "institution": "King's College London", "dateline": "Sept 2019 – June 2020", "bullets": ["Awarded Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding awarded toward undergraduate degree"]], "experience": [{"employer": "Citizens Advice East Berkshire", "location": "Maidenhead", "role": "Legal Adviser", "dateline": "July 2026 – Present", "bullets": ["Manages a high volume of concurrent client matters: maintains accurate and confidential case records, processes applications, drafts correspondence and meets filing deadlines consistently", "Assesses client eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifying evidential gaps and researching complex points — requires careful, systematic data handling", "Coordinates matters from initial instruction through to submission: prepares document schedules, tracks outstanding actions and ensures all records are kept current and complete", "Communicates directly with clients about procedural requirements and next steps, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance"]}, {"employer": "Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP)", "location": "London", "role": "Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration", "dateline": "Aug 2023 – Feb 2024", "bullets": ["Maintained structured electronic case files across a complex investment arbitration using iManage; monitored procedural deadlines and tracked outstanding actions", "Coordinated document flows and managed competing priorities as the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant submission deadline — contributed to on-time delivery", "Liaised with the client on required documentation; coordinated external translation workflows with a Romanian translator", "Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor"]}, {"employer": "Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP)", "location": "London", "role": "Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes", "dateline": "Feb 2024 – Aug 2024", "bullets": ["Prepared electronic hearing bundles and court materials, managing large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines", "Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons — broad administrative support across a busy disputes team", "Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted fee earners with research, client notes and procedural documentation"]}, {"employer": "Adobe", "location": "London", "role": "Legal Intern", "dateline": "June 2022 – Aug 2022", "bullets": ["Reviewed and processed software licensing and confidentiality documentation; flagged provisions requiring legal input and communicated amendments to internal stakeholders", "Liaised across sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial requirements with internal compliance standards", "Supported acceptance workflows for standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation for accuracy, tracked outstanding items and ensured timely escalation", "Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on contractual risk and mitigation"]}]}

measures"]},{ "employer": "Q-Legal", "location": "Remote", "role": "Legal Adviser", "dateline": "Oct 2024 – Jan 2025", "bullets": ["Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under qualified solicitor supervision", "Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations", "Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline"], "skills": [{"label": "Languages", "text": "Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)"}, {"label": "Technical skills", "text": "Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage document management system; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review and electronic bundling tools; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence writing"}, {"label": "Case and evidence management", "text": "High-volume document handling, structured case-file organisation, deadline and action tracking, electronic bundle preparation, matter opening and closure administration"}]}}